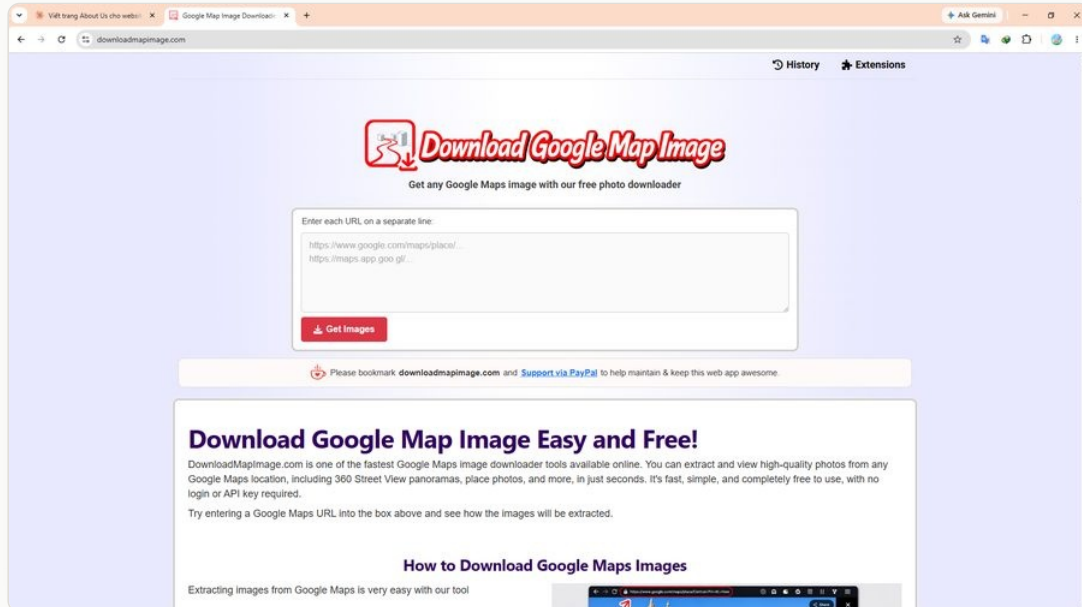


How to Download a Google Map Photo Using Only the Link

A faster alternative to screenshots. No tools, no accounts required.



DownloadMapImage.com: paste any Google Maps link and retrieve photos in seconds.

A few years ago I was working on a local SEO project, and someone handed me a spreadsheet of 100 Google Maps business links and asked me to collect photos for each one. My method at the time was embarrassingly manual: open the link, wait for Maps to load, find the photo gallery, screenshot it, crop out the browser chrome, save, rename, repeat.

After about twenty locations, I stopped and thought: I already have the link. Why am I doing all of this by hand?

That question completely changed how I work with Google Maps images. And the short answer, which I'll walk you through in this article, is that you don't need any of that. If you have a Google Maps URL, downloading the photo takes about 30 seconds.

Why People Need Google Maps Photos in the First Place

Most people think of Google Maps as a navigation tool. But after years of using it professionally, I've come to see the photo library inside Google Maps as one of the most underrated visual resources on the internet.

Businesses upload their own storefront and interior shots. Customers add real-world photos that no official website has. Google's Local Guides document places that have

never been formally photographed. The result is a massive, constantly updated collection of authentic location imagery.

I've personally pulled Google Maps photos for travel articles, neighborhood research, restaurant guides, real estate comparisons, and local business directories. The common frustration across all of those projects was always the same: there's no download button.

Why Screenshots Are Not the Answer

I spent a long time relying on screenshots before I realized how much quality I was giving up. The fundamental problem is that a screenshot only captures what's currently rendered on your screen, which is almost never the full-resolution version of the image.

If your browser window is small, the screenshot is small. If Google Maps is showing a compressed preview, that's what you capture. By the time you crop out the browser interface and resize for a website or document, the image quality has usually degraded noticeably. On a larger monitor or in print, the difference becomes obvious.

For a one-off personal use, this might not matter. But if you're working with dozens or hundreds of locations, whether writing a travel guide, running an SEO campaign, or building a business directory, the quality inconsistency adds up fast and the time cost is real.

The Better Way: Start from the URL

Here's the insight that changed my workflow. A Google Maps URL already contains all the information needed to identify a specific place and its images. So instead of manually navigating to the photo gallery every time, you can paste that URL into a dedicated tool and let it retrieve the photos directly.

That's exactly what [DownloadMapImage.com](https://downloadmapimage.com) does. Paste in a Google Maps link, whether it's a full desktop URL or a short maps.app.goo.gl share link from your phone, and the tool fetches the available photos for that location. No account needed, no installation, no technical knowledge required. Just paste and click **Get Images**.

THE TOOL

downloadmapimage.com

How It Works: Desktop Workflow

On desktop, the process takes under a minute. Here are the exact steps:

1

Go to Google Maps and open the image in **full size** (important).

2

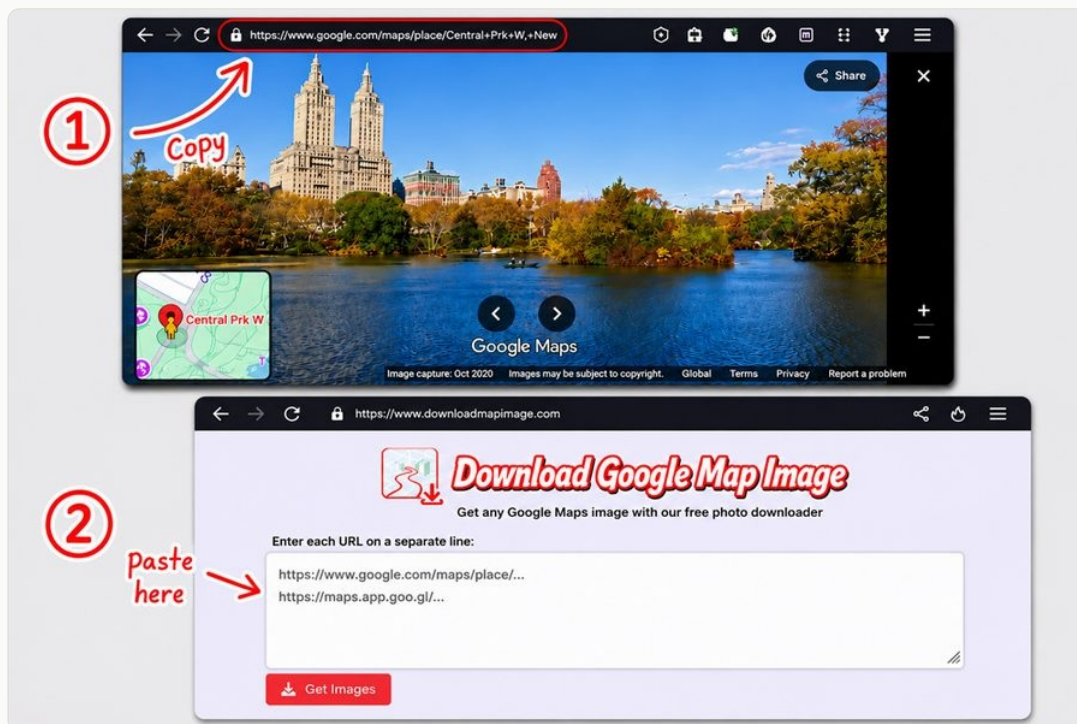
Copy the URL from the browser address bar.

3

Paste it into DownloadMapImage.com and click **Get Images**.

4

View and download the extracted photo from the result page.



Step 1: copy the URL from the Google Maps address bar. Step 2: paste it into DownloadMapImage.com and click Get Images.

How It Works: Mobile Workflow

DownloadMapImage.com fully supports the short `maps.app.goo.gl` links you get when sharing from the Google Maps app. A lot of similar tools only work with the full desktop URL, which means an extra step of re-opening the place on a computer. Here, the short link works directly.

1

Open Google Maps app and tap the image to view it in **full size**.

2

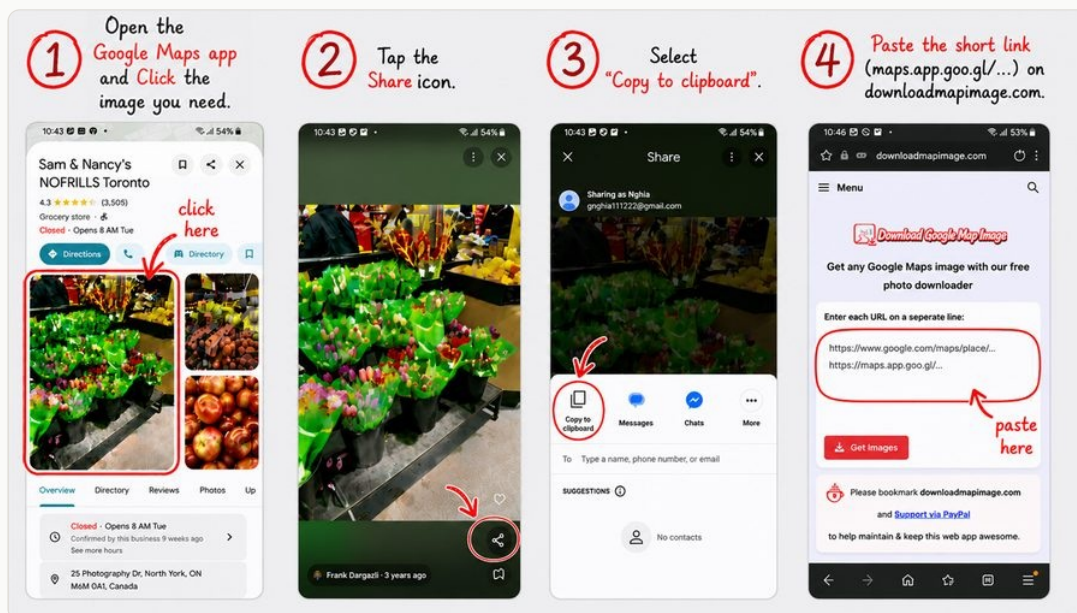
Tap the **Share icon** shown on the image.

3

Choose **Copy to clipboard**.

4

Paste the link on DownloadMapImage.com and click **Get Images**.



On mobile: tap the Share icon on the image, choose "Copy to clipboard," then paste the short link on [DownloadMapImage.com](https://downloadmapimage.com).

What You Can Download

- Place and business photos uploaded by owners or customers
- Street View panoramas (360° images) in high resolution
- Multiple URLs at once: paste one URL per line and process them all in a single click
- Both full desktop URLs and short `maps.app.goo.gl` mobile links
- Images are retrieved in the highest resolution available from Google

Who Actually Uses This

Before I started recommending this tool to others, I assumed it was mainly useful for marketers and SEO people. Turns out the use cases are much broader.

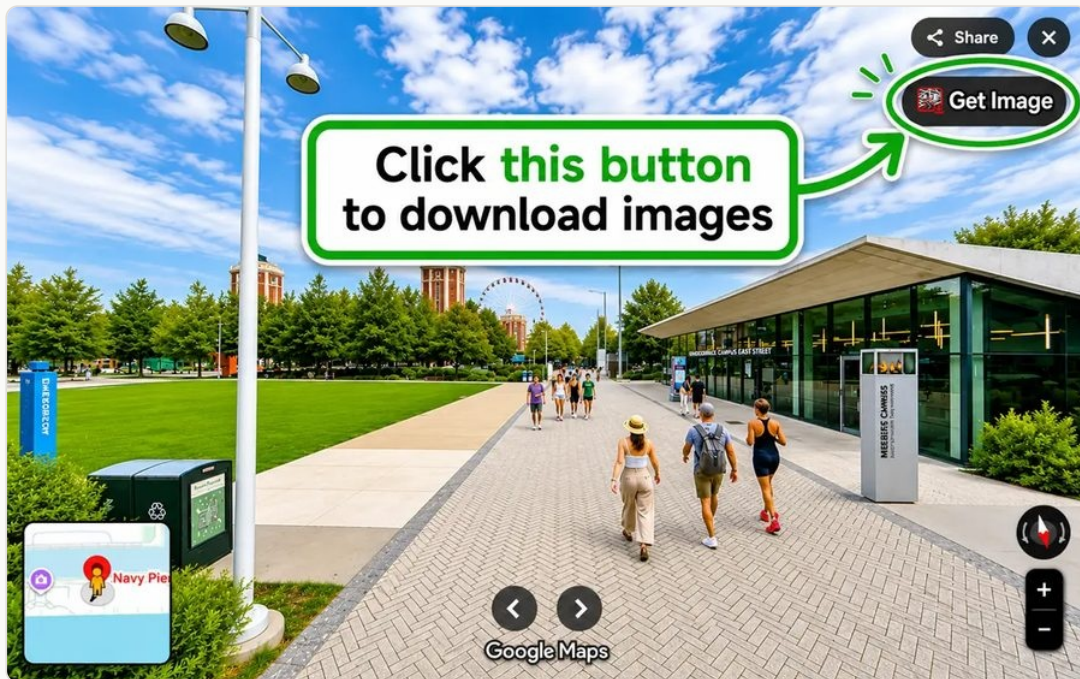
Travel bloggers use it to build destination guides without having to visit every location in person. Real estate professionals pull street-level and storefront imagery when preparing property comparisons. Journalists need quick visual references for local businesses. Researchers archive business photos over time to document urban change. Students assembling presentations about cities or landmarks save hours they would otherwise spend opening and screenshotting individual listings.

The common thread: they all start with a Google Maps link. That's the only prerequisite.

When the Browser Extension Makes More Sense

The web tool works great for occasional use. But if Google Maps is open in your browser for several hours a day, whether researching businesses, checking cities, or reviewing listings, constantly switching tabs to paste links gets old fast.

For that kind of workflow, the DownloadMapImage browser extension is worth installing. It adds a **Get Image** button directly on Google Maps pages so you can download any photo or Street View panorama in one click, without leaving the page.



The browser extension adds a "Get Image" button right inside Google Maps. No tab-switching, no URL copying.

The extension is available for Chrome, Firefox, and Edge. All three are free.

● Chrome Web Store

● Firefox Add-ons

● Microsoft Edge Add-ons

BROWSER EXTENSION

downloadmapimage.com/extensions

A Few Mistakes Worth Avoiding

The most common one: people copy the Google Search results URL instead of the actual Google Maps image URL. Make sure you're on `maps.google.com` and that you have opened the image in full size before copying the URL. Copying the location URL without opening the image first will not work.

The second mistake is expecting every listing to have lots of photos. Some businesses have hundreds of user-contributed images; others have two. That's a function of how active the listing is, not a limitation of the downloader.

And finally, you don't need to know anything technical to use this. No developer tools, no browser tricks, no understanding of how Google serves images. Open the image, copy the URL, paste it in, done.

Quick FAQ

Can I use a short `maps.app.goo.gl` link?

+
Is it free? +
Do I need to create an account? +
Why are no images showing up for my URL? +
Is it faster than screenshots? +
Can I process multiple URLs at once? +

Final Thoughts

If I had discovered this earlier, I would have saved a lot of hours on projects that didn't need to be that manual. The screenshot habit is hard to break because it feels fast in the moment, but over time, the quality limitations and repetitive steps add up.

The link-based approach is genuinely simpler once you try it. Open the image on Google Maps, copy the URL, paste it into DownloadMapImage.com, click Get Images, pick your photos, move on. That's really all there is to it.

Ready to skip the screenshots for good?

Try DownloadMapImage.com Free